



WARTBURG CASTLE

THE MOST
DISTINGUISHED
SURNAME
BOWER

TABLE OF CONTENTS

SURNAME HISTORY

Ancient Origins	3
Ancient History	3
Spelling Variations	3
Early History	5
Early Notables	6
The Great Migration	7
Current Notables	8
Historic Events	8

SURNAME SYMBOLISM

Introduction	II
Motto	12
Shield	12
Crest	17

FURTHER READINGS AND BIBLIOGRAPHY

Suggested Further Readings	19
Appendix - Notable List	19
Appendix - Historic Event List	23
Appendix - Settler List	35
Bibliography	39
Citations	42





ANCIENT ORIGINS

The historical and enchanting region of Austria is the birthplace of the distinguished family name Bower. Austria, which was originally home to a Celtic people, was conquered by the Roman Empire in about 15 BC. Following the fall of Rome, Austria was repeatedly invaded by barbarian tribes, such as the Vandals, Visigoths, and Huns, who swept in from the east. During the 5th and 6th centuries, the Alemanni, Avars and Slavs settled Austria. The Avars were defeated in 785 by the Frankish emperor Charlemagne, who set up the East Mark, which later became known as the Österreich. Otto I defeated the Magyars in 955. Austria was ruled by the Babenburger dynasty until 1278, when they were succeeded by the Hapsburg dynasty, which ruled Austria until the 20th century.

ANCIENT HISTORY

The distinguished surname Bower has been traced to the ancient nation of Austria. Later becoming the Bavarian tribal territories of Upper Austria, Salzburg, and Tyrol, the area had been occupied by the Celts and then the Romans. Between the 3rd and 5th centuries there came a series of invasions by the Vandals, Goths, Huns, and Allemands, who swept into this mountainous region from the east. In the 9th century, the Holy Roman Emperor Charlemagne made this territory the "Ostmark," meaning eastern border region, as a bulwark against the determined Hungarian and Slavic armies, who wanted Austria for their own. Otto the Great finally defeated the Hungarian invasions in 955, and Austria, a word meaning "Kingdom of the East," was a Bavarian protectorate.

Research into the history of this name brings us to Austria and Bavaria, where the name contributed greatly to the development of an emerging nation which would later play a large role in the tribal and national conflicts of the area. In later years the name branched into many houses, each playing a significant role in the local social and political affairs.

SPELLING VARIATIONS

Throughout history most surnames have gone through changes in spelling, even between generations. Often a name was recorded by a scribe simply by the way it sounded, thus changing the way in which the name was written. If the name change had been recorded in contracts or legal proceedings, that name's spelling often became a part of standard usage. Thus depending on the region, a name's spelling may vary quite considerably. Among such variations of the name are Bauer, Baur, Bauerr, Bauerre, Bower, Boerema, Bohr, Burr and Burrs, to name a few examples.





The Babenberger dynasty ruled Austria until 1278, when the house of Habsburg rose to power and began a vast program of territorial expansion, not by going to war, but by going to the altar; by marrying into various influential houses, the Habsburgs acquired Tyrol, the Krain region, Styria, Trieste, and the Alemanian Voralberg. They also gained the Netherlands from the Dukes of Burgundy in 1482, and married into the Spanish royal family. Charles V left his Austrian territories to his brother Ferdinand I, who acquired Hungary and Bohemia in 1526.

Austria faced in the 16th century the religious troubles of the Reformation and the expansion of the Turkish Empire. Austria became the Catholic center of the Counter-Reformation, and despite Ferdinand's expanding power, the Turks laid siege to Vienna in 1529. The Treaty of Westphalia (1648) put an end to the Thirty Years War and divided up the Empire. The Turks again invaded Austria in 1699, only to be driven back by Prince Eugene of Savoy, who conquered large parts of the Balkans, acquiring Transylvania. However, after the Spanish and Austrian lines of Habsburg died out in 1700 and 1740, Maria Theresa became the only woman to be Empress on a German throne. Ruling a twin monarchy, they also became Kings of Hungary, which became the basis for the powerful Austro-Hungarian Empire.

Meanwhile, the surname Bower has been traced to Austria, which was established as the primary origin of the family name. The name flourished in this region for several centuries throughout the early Middle Ages. Later, from the mid 16th century, the family name migrated to Bavaria and Prussia as family members pursued their varied interests, sometimes in the military, sometimes in the religious milieu, and sometimes in politics. Of the many prominent Austrian branches, the Bauer zu Loostorf are perhaps the oldest. Christoph Bauer zu Loostorf was a knight of Vienna in 1524. His daughter, Ursula, married the knight and Doctor of Law Leopold von Pernfuss in 1538. Other important Austrian Bauer lines were the von Ehrenfeld, the von Ehrenbau, the von Ehersfeld, and the von Adelsbach. All of these lines were ennobled during the 18th century, the latter family in the person of

Dr. Joseph Heinrich Bauer, a noted physician in Prague. Of the Bavarian branches, the Bauer von Breitenfeld were the most prominent. Johann Fidel Bauer von Breitenfeld became a count in 1781. Of the Prussian branches, Friedrich Wilhelm Bauer was ennobled in 1761 for his service as commander of the castle in Hanover. He later went to Russia where he was highly honored for his accomplishments as director of all the salt mines of the country and chief engineer of the water system.

EARLY NOTABLES

Notable bearers of the name Bower before the 20th century include Bruno Bauer (1809-1882), who was a controversial German theologian, historian, and student of Hegel. Ludwig Amandus Bauer (1803-1846) was a pastor and playwright and boyhood friend of the poet E. Moerike. Adolf Bauerle (1786-1859) was the author of more than seventy plays about Viennese life.





Following the defeat of Napoleon in 1815, Vienna was chosen as the site of the famous Congress of Vienna, at which the victors decided how the nations of Europe were to share the spoils. Following this period Austria reached the peak of its prestige, although the regime had difficulty controlling the vast array of nationalities and cultures under its control.

SETTLERS

- Henry Bower who settled in Virginia in 1637
- Richard Bower, who arrived in Maryland in 1664^[1]
- Samuel Bower, who landed in Maryland in 1668^[1]
- Mary Bower, who landed in Maryland in 1678^[1]
- Robert Bower, who settled in Virginia in 1698
- William Bower, who landed in Virginia in 1706^[1]
- Susanna Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1732^[1]
- Martin Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1732^[1]
- Barbara Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1732^[1]
- Helena Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1732^[1]
- Chrisn Bower, aged 17, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1737^[1]
- Michell Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1737^[1]
- Johan Nicklas Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1738^[1]
- John Peter Bower, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1738^[1]
- Petter Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1739^[1]
- John Paul Bower, aged 23, who landed in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania in 1741^[1]

As well as 76 more in the Appendix.



Almost 70 percent of the immigrants landing in the United States arrived through the port of New York. From there they followed opportunities into the North American heartland.

- John William "Johnny" Bower (1924-2017) born John William Kiszkan, Canadian hockey goaltender, inducted into the Hockey Hall of Fame in 1976, one of the "100 Greatest NHL Players" in history
- Tom Bower (1938-2024) born Ralph Thomas Bower, an American actor who appeared in film roles, including Die Hard 2 and The Bad Lieutenant: Port of Call New Orleans
- Thomas Ralph Bower (1938-2024) American actor, best known for roles in Die Hard 2 (1990), Raising Cain (1992) and High Crimes (2002)
- Prof. Denise Ann Bower O.B.E., British Professor for Engineering Project Management at the University of Leeds, appointed Officer of the Order of the British Empire on 8th June 2018, for services to the Engineering and Construction Industries^[2]
- Thomas Bower (1838-1919) English architect particularly associated with the Gothic Revival style of architecture
- Sir William Bower (1840-1928) English merchant and politician
- Sir Roger Bower (1903-1990) English Lieutenant General with the King's Own Yorkshire Light Infantry
- Norman Adolph Henry Bower (1907-1990) British politician, Member of the UK Parliament (1941-1951)
- Dallas Bower (1907-1999) English film director and screenwriter
- Robert Bower (1894-1975) English Commander in the Royal Navy
- Frederick Orpen Bower FRS (1855-1948) British botanist awarded the Gold Medal of the Linnean Society in 1909 and the Darwin Medal of the Royal Society in 1938

As well as 91 more in the Appendix.



- Mr. Frank Bower, British Stoker 1st Class, who sailed into battle on the HMS Repulse (1941) and died in the sinking^[3]
- E Bower (d.1979) American passenger from Newport Beach, California, USA, who flew aboard American Airlines Flight 191 and died in the crash^[4]
- Mr. Ronald Bower (b.1920) English Stoker 1st Class serving for the Royal Navy from Marlpool, Derbyshire, England, who sailed into battle and died in the HMS Hood sinking^[5]
- Mr. Reginald P Bower (b.1923) English Able Seaman serving for the Royal Navy from Westbourne, Hampshire, England, who sailed into battle and died in the HMS Hood sinking^[5]
- Mr. Jordon Michael Bower (1979-1996) from Montoursville, Pennsylvania, USA, American student from Montoursville flying aboard flight TWA 800 from J.F.K. Airport, New York to Leonardo da Vinci Airport, Rome when the plane crashed after takeoff ; he died in the crash^[6]

As well as 16 more in the Appendix.



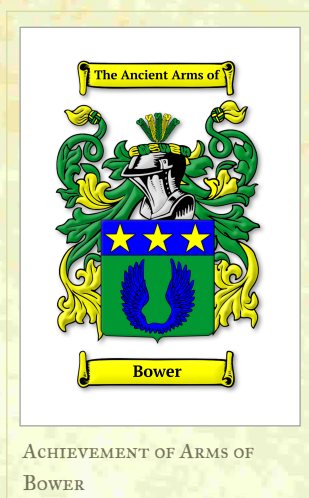
The Ancient Arms of



Bower



In the feudal states of the Holy Roman Empire, that at one time encompassed most of eastern Europe, it was especially important to be able to identify enemies from allies because of the many conflicts that occurred there. A system of heraldry evolved that achieved this. It regulated what arms were borne, and allowed each of the German knights to be distinguishable from others.



An Achievement of Arms such as the Bower arms depicted on the left typically consists of these parts: the Escrolls, displaying the family motto and name, the family crest (if any) seen above the helmet, the actual Coat of arms (also known as 'arms,' or 'the shield'), the Helmet depicted below the crest, the Torse on top of the helmet, and the Mantle draped from the helmet. Each of these elements will be described below. Supporters were a later addition to the Achievement; they are somewhat rare, and are usually personal to the grantee.



MANTLE OF BOWER

The mantle was spread over and draped from the helmet and served as a protection, 'to repel the extremities of wet, cold, and heat, and to preserve the armour from rust.' The numerous cuts and slits suggest that it had been torn and hacked on the field of battle. The style or design of the mantling is up to the individual heraldic artist, and it is usually depicted in the main color and metal from the shield. The helmet (or Helm) varied in shape in different ages and countries, often depicting rank. The Esquire's Helm, as depicted here, is generally shown silver, with a closed visor and facing to the dexter (its right). On top of the helmet is a Torse or wreath which was formed by two pieces of silk twisted together. Its purpose was to hold the crest and mantle on the Helm.

MOTTO

The motto was originally a war cry or slogan. Mottoes first began to be shown with arms in the 14th and 15th centuries, but were not in general use until the 17th century. Thus the oldest coats of arms generally do not include a motto. Mottoes seldom form part of the grant of arms: Under most heraldic authorities, a motto is an optional component of the coat of arms, and can be added to or changed at will; many families have chosen not to display a motto.

The coat of arms displayed here for the surname Bower did not include a motto.

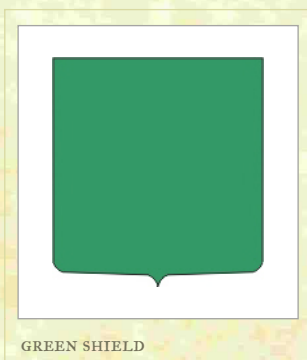
SHIELD

Shields (or Escutcheons) at first were painted simply with one or more bands of color or 'ordinaries'. Later, the ordinaries were used in conjunction with other figures or symbols. The Coat of Arms for the surname Bower can be described as follows:



BOWER ARMS

A green shield with blue wings and three gold stars on a blue chief.



GREEN SHIELD

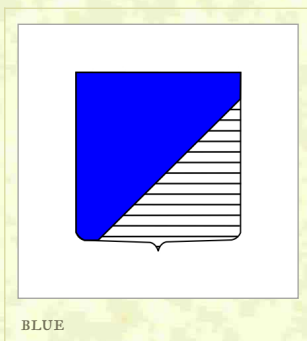
"Vert" (from the French word for green) signifies felicity and pleasure. It was symbolic of joy, youth and beauty. Green was also associated with the spring. The bearer of the green is obliged to defend the peasant and all who work on the land. It is expressed in engravings by lines in bend, or slanting to the right.

Symbolic Virtues: Green denotes the virtues of charity and hope, as well as the qualities of honor, courtesy and abundance.

Precious Stone: Emerald

Planet: Venus

Obligations: To defend the peasant and all who work on the land



BLUE

Azure (derived from the French word for "blue") represents the color of an eastern sky on a clear day. It also corresponds to the metal tin. The word, "azure" was introduced from the east during the Crusades. It signifies piety and sincerity, and is equated with autumn. In engravings it is represented by horizontal lines.



WINGS

WINGS

Wings are symbols of speed and protection. They are also religious emblems of justice and spirituality.

Many European crests are blazoned to appear between a pair of wings, also called a "vol."

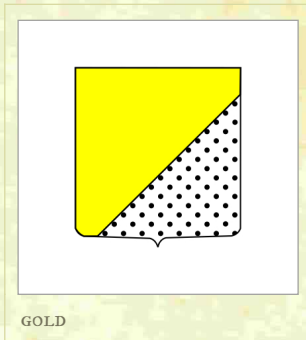
THREE

"Three" devices, beasts or ordinaries of the same have a special significance in heraldry.

First of all, there is the obvious reference to the Trinity in the design that would signify observance of the Christian doctrine.

Secondly, with many Arms it brings balance that is steeped in tradition. To better understand this latter scenario, we must look at the evolution of shield in personal armory. Kite shields that were the most popular from the the 10th-14th century evolved into Heater shields that had flat tops c. 1250. This was the time of heraldry's beginnings and when "three" objects were used for balance in each corner of the shield.

Later, with the advent of the "chief," "chevron" and "bend" three devices brought balance to these ordinaries too.



GOLD

"Or" (from the French word for gold) is the tincture of Gold, or in heraldic terms "or," was considered the noblest color.

One of only two metals used in heraldry, it exceeds all others in value, purity and finesse. It represents the light of the sun, and was once borne only by princes. Gold is said to gladden the heart and destroy all works of magic. It is also associated with excellence and achievement, and the bearer surpasses all others in valor.

It is represented on coats of arms by the color yellow, and in engravings by a dotted pattern.



STARS

In heraldry, the Star, or Mullet, is often considered a symbol of truth, the spirit and of hope.

"Guillim holds that this is a falling or fallen star, not supposed to be fallen from its high estate, but to denote some Divine quality bestowed from above, whereby men shine in virtue, learning, and works of piety like bright stars on the earth." ^[7]

The Star can denote a divine quality and is a symbol of constancy, and celestial goodness. Its meaning can also depend upon the number and sometimes the orientation of its points. A star of some form constitutes part of the insignia of every order of knighthood.

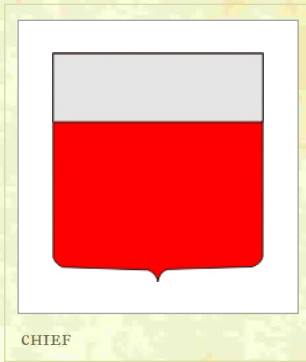
"A gold spur becomes the dignity of knighthood, and a silver spur for that of an esquire." ^[8]

"From the French word molette, the rowel of a spur." ^[9]

Many cultures throughout antiquity have used the star as a talisman or national insignia. In England, a Mullet has five points unless another number is specified, while an Estoile (a wavy star) will have six.

"There was an ancient English order entitled 'Esquires of the Silver Spur,' which has been slightly revived in the present reign, and such a creation affords a ready means of constituting one as a legal esquire should he hold no office to which such a title is affixed by usage." ^[7]

In Scotland, a Mullet is always pierced (has a hole in the center), while a Star is not. In France, the definition of a Mullet is different yet again, where it has no less than six points.



CHIEF

The Chief is a horizontal band across the top of the shield that stands for authority and domination of will.

The Chief has often been granted as a special reward for prudence and wisdom, as well as for successful command in war and is accordingly, one of the honourable ordinaires. ^[9]

The Chief theoretically contains the upper 1/3 of the shield, although it rarely actually does. The Chief is never surmounted by any other ordinary (a simple background symbol) except for in very exceptional cases.

THE CREST

The Crest was worn on top of the helmet, and was usually made of wood, metal, or boiled leather. It provided the double advantage of easy identification and the addition of height to the wearer. If a family had no crest, and many chose not to, plumes (feathers) were often displayed instead.



SUGGESTED FURTHER READINGS

"The Family Band: From the Missouri to the Black Hills, 1881-1900" by Lauran Bower Van Nuys.

Please note: We do not have these publications in our library. They come from the catalog of Genealogical titles in the collection of the Library of Congress. Most of these Genealogies were published by their authors, probably with one small print run. You can locate these publications through the Library of Congress (<http://catalog.loc.gov/webvoy.htm>), or we would suggest trying to contact a library in the locale of publication (you may be able to use inter-library loan, through your local library).





APPENDIX - NOTABLE LIST

NOTABLES FOR THE SURNAME BOWER

- John William "Johnny" Bower (1924-2017) born John William Kiszkan, Canadian hockey goaltender, inducted into the Hockey Hall of Fame in 1976, one of the "100 Greatest NHL Players" in history
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- Robert Bower (1894-1975) English Commander in the Royal Navy
- Frederick Orpen Bower FRS (1855-1948) British botanist awarded the Gold Medal of the Linnean Society in 1909 and the Darwin Medal of the Royal Society in 1938
- William Horton Bower (1850-1910) American Democratic Party politician, U.S. Representative from North Carolina 8th District, 1893-95 [10]
- William G. Bower, American politician, Member of North Carolina House of Commons from Granville County, 1823-24 [10]
- W. W. Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Wyoming, 1940 [10]
- W. C. Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from North Carolina, 1888 [10]
- Roy E. B. Bower, American politician, U.S. Vice Consul in Southampton, 1926-29; U.S. Consul in Singapore, 1932; Madras, 1943 [10]

- Ross K. Bower (1901-1988) American Republican politician, Mayor of Ypsilanti, Michigan, 1940-46^[10]
- Robert Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Member, Rules Committee, Democratic National Convention, 2008^[10]
- Ray F. Bower, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Wyoming, 1956^[10]
- Paul Bower (1911-1960) American Democratic Party politician, Member of West Virginia State House of Delegates from Wyoming County, 1953-58^[10]
- Nelson L. Bower, American Republican politician, Supervisor of Romulus Township, Michigan; Elected 1940, 1941; Elected unopposed 1942; Elected 1949, 1953^[10]
- Matti Herrera Bower, American politician, Mayor of Miami Beach, Florida, 2008-^[10]
- Lynne Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Alternate Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Colorado, 1980^[10]
- Lucy W. Bower, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Iowa, 1940^[10]
- Joseph A. Bower, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from New Jersey, 1940; Treasurer of New Jersey Republican Party, 1943^[10]
- John White Bower, American politician, Delegate to Texas Consultation of 1835 from District of San Patricio, 1835^[10]
- John P. Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Member of Ohio State House of Representatives from Logan County; Elected 1897^[10]
- H. A. Bower, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Oklahoma, 1912^[10]
- Gustavus Miller Bower (1790-1864) American Democratic Party politician, U.S. Representative from Missouri at-large, 1843-45^[10]
- Glen L. Bower, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Illinois, 1972^[10]
- Gladys Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Alternate Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Illinois, 1952^[10]
- Gail E. Bower Jr., American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from New Hampshire, 1952, 1956^[10]
- Ernest A. Bower, American Republican politician, Candidate in primary for Michigan State Senate 7th District, 1942^[10]
- Emma E. Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Michigan, 1920^[10]
- Edwin Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Chair of Snyder County Democratic Party, 1927; Alternate Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Pennsylvania, 1928^[10]
- Edward A. Bower (b.1869) American Republican politician, Druggist; Member of Massachusetts State House of Representatives Sixth Essex District, 1905-06^[10]

- Earl T. Bower, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Wyoming, 1940 (alternate), 1960; Member of Wyoming State Senate, 1950; Presidential Elector for Wyoming, 1956 ^[10]
- E. S. Bower, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Kansas, 1912 ^[10]
- E. G. Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Texas, 1876 ^[10]
- E. C. Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Georgia, 1876 ^[10]
- David Bower, American politician, Member of New York State Assembly from Tompkins County, 1839 ^[10]
- Clark M. Bower, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Pennsylvania, 1924 ^[10]
- Charles C. Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Candidate for U.S. Representative from Indiana 13th District, 1900 ^[10]
- C. O. Bower, American Democratic Party politician, Member of West Virginia State House of Delegates from Calhoun County, 1955-56; Defeated, 1962 ^[10]
- Burney E. Bower, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Michigan, 1932 ^[10]
- Andrew P. Bower, American politician, Candidate for Presidential Elector for Pennsylvania, 1900, 1904 ^[10]
- Alfred Bower, American Republican politician, Supervisor of Romulus Township, Michigan; Elected 1923 ^[10]
- Alexander Bower, American politician, Member of New York State Assembly from Tompkins County 1st District, 1857 ^[10]

SURNAME VARIANTS OF BOWER

- Daniel Bohr (1943-2026) Argentine-born Danish stage director and theatre manager
- William Joseph Bauer (1926-2025) American jurist, Senior Judge of the United States Court of Appeals for the Seventh Circuit (1994-2025)
- Michael Boyers (1948-2025) English cricketer, a right-handed batsman and right-arm medium-fast bowler who played for Essex
- Jutta Bauer (1955-2025) German writer and illustrator of children's books, received the Hans Christian Andersen Medal in 2010 for her "lasting contribution" as a children's illustrator
- John William Bowers (1928-2025) American writer
- Theresia Bauer (b.1965) German politician, Member of the Landtag of Baden-Württemberg (2001-2024)
- Yehuda Bauer (1926-2024) Czech-born Israeli historian and scholar of the Holocaust
- Helmut Bauer (1937-2024) German Roman Catholic prelate
- Vladimir Valeryevich Bure (1950-2024) Russian and Soviet freestyle swimmer and a fitness coach

- Lyle Bauer (1958-2024) Canadian professional football player and executive in the Canadian Football League (CFL), three-time Grey Cup champion (1984, 1988, 1990)
- Gerd Bauer (1950-2023) German politician who served in the Landtag of Saarland from 1994 to 2001
- William Edward Bauer (1926-2023) Canadian diplomat, Ambassador Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary to Laos and Thailand then Myanmar
- Josef Bauer (1934-2022) Austrian artist, born in Wels, Austria
- William Joseph Boarman (1946-2021) American printer who served as the 26th Public Printer of the United States (2010-2012)
- Mr. John W. Bowers, British sheriff, who held the position of Sheriff of Nottingham, England from 1869 to 1870, he was Mayor in 1876
- Albert Bauer (1928-2021) American politician, Member of the Washington Senate (1981-2001)
- Romanus R. Bour, American Democratic Party politician, Alternate Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Ohio, 1916^[11]
- Justin De Witt Bowersock (1842-1922) American politician from Columbiana, Ohio, Member of the U.S. House of Representatives from Kansas (1899-1907)
- Jane Dee Bowersock (b.1935) birth name of Jane Dee Hull, an American politician, 20th Governor of Arizona (1997-2003), 16th Secretary of State of Arizona (1995-1997), 36th Speaker of the Arizona House of Representatives (1989-1992)
- J. P. Bowersock, American musician, guitarist, performer and record producer

NOTABLES WITH THE FIRST AND MIDDLE NAMES BOWER

- Sir Arthur Bower Forwood PC MP (1836-1898) 1st Baronet of The Priory, Gateacre, Lancashire, an English merchant, shipowner, and politician, Parliamentary and Financial Secretary to the Admiralty from 1886 to 1892
- Dr Joseph Bower Siddall (1840-1925) British physician and foreign advisor in Japan; a strong proponent of the universal vaccination for Smallpox
- Major-General Edmund Bower Sebree (1898-1966) American Deputy Commanding General 1st Army (1953-1954)^[12]
- Bower Slack Broadus (1888-1949) American politician, U.S. District Judge for Oklahoma, 1940-49^[13]





APPENDIX - HISTORIC EVENT LIST

BISMARCK

On May 24th, 1941, the Battle of the Denmark Strait began. On the allied side, the HMS Prince of Wales and the HMS Hood were fighting the German Battleship Bismarck and the heavy cruiser Prinz Eugen. After less than ten minutes, the Bismarck had hit HMS Hood and she exploded, sinking three minutes later.

Thus began the Royal Navy's relentless pursuit of the Bismarck involving dozens of warships. Damaged from the battle, the Bismarck was forced to retreat. Heading to France she was pursued by British ship and aircraft.

On May 26th 1941 after breaking radio silence, her peruses caught up with and caused further damage forcing the crew to scuttle her and abandon ship. She sunk with a crew of over 2,200 men of these only 114 survived most picked up by the British ships before a German U Boat entered the area to rescue three and later a trawler scooped the last crew member from the water.



BISMARCK

SURNAME VARIANTS OF BOWER

- Arno Bauer (1919-1941) German Mechanikersgefreiter who served aboard the German Battleship Bismarck during World War II when it was sunk heading to France; he died in the sinking^[14]
- Anton Bauer (1920-1941) German Maschinengefreiter who served aboard the German Battleship Bismarck during World War II when it was sunk heading to France; he died in the sinking^[14]
- Erich Bauer (1920-1941) German Matrosengefreiter who served aboard the German Battleship Bismarck during World War II when it was sunk heading to France; he died in the sinking^[14]
- Fritz Herbert Bauer (1921-1941) German Maschinengefreiter who served aboard the German Battleship Bismarck during World War II when it was sunk heading to France; he died in the sinking^[14]
- Johannes Bauer (1921-1941) German Maschinengefreiter who served aboard the German Battleship Bismarck during World War II when it was sunk heading to France; he died in the sinking^[14]

FLIGHT 191

American Airlines Flight 191 traveling from O'Hare International Airport, Chicago, USA to Los Angeles International Airport, Los Angeles, California, USA on May 25, 1979 when the Left Wing engine number 1 separated causing the plane to crash killing all 258 passengers and 13 crew traveling aboard the McDonnell Douglas CD-10-10.



FLIGHT 191

- E Bower (d.1979) American passenger from Newport Beach, California, USA, who flew aboard American Airlines Flight 191 and died in the crash ^[4]

FLIGHT TWA 800

Flight TWA 800 was a Boeing 747-100 leaving from J.F.K. International Airport flying to Rome, Italy with a stopover in Paris, France on July 17, 1996 carrying 18 crew members and 20 off duty employees and 192 passengers including a French Club of students and chaperones from Montoursville High School. Approximately 8.31 pm EDT, 12 minutes after takeoff, the plane exploded and crashed in the Atlantic Ocean, many investigations followed with F.B.I. investigations and NTSB investigations it was concluded that the fuel vapors in the fuel tank exploded via a possible short circuit killing all 230 aboard the flight.



FLIGHT TWA 800

- Mr. Jordon Michael Bower (1979-1996) from Montoursville, Pennsylvania, USA, American student from Montoursville flying aboard flight TWA 800 from J.F.K. Airport, New York to Leonardo da Vinci Airport, Rome when the plane crashed after takeoff ; he died in the crash ^[6]

HALIFAX EXPLOSION

In the morning of December 6, 1917 the cargo ship SS Mont-Blanc carrying high explosives collided with the Norwegian SS Imo causing a devastating explosion that affected the Richmond district in Halifax, Nova Scotia. Around 2,000 people died due to the debris and the fires from the blast wave that radiated over 1,000 metres per second.



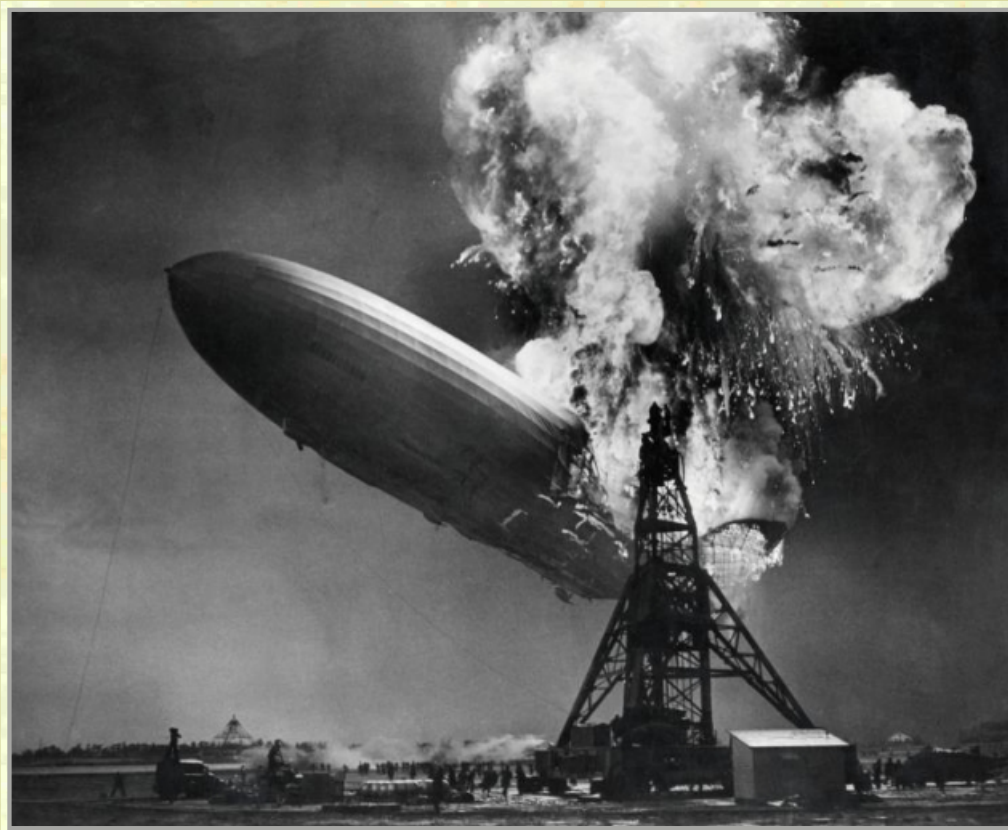
HALIFAX EXPLOSION

SURNAME VARIANTS OF BOWER

- Mrs. Nora Bauer, Canadian resident from Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada who died in the Halifax Explosion (1917)^[15]
- Mr. Middleton Bell Bauer (1850-1917) Canadian resident from Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada who died in the Halifax Explosion (1917)^[15]
- Mr. Ralph Bauer (1898-1917) Canadian resident from Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada who died in the Halifax Explosion (1917)^[15]
- Miss Jean Bauer (1913-1917) Canadian resident from Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada who died in the Halifax Explosion (1917)^[15]

HINDENBURG LZ-129

During its attempt to dock at Lakehurst Naval Air Station, New Jersey, USA the Hindenburg LZ-129 caught fire on May 6, 1937. The German passenger airship was carrying 36 passengers and 61 crewman at the time of the incident. Thirty-five people aboard the LZ-129 Hindenburg died as well as one member of the ground crew.



HINDENBURG LZ-129

SURNAME VARIANTS OF BOWER

- Captain Heinrich Bauer (1902-1937) German Wath officer from Frankfurt, Germany, who worked on board the Hindenburg LZ-129 and survived the Airship Fire^[16]
- Mr. Kurt Bauer (1907-1937) German Navigator from Buchschlag, Germany, who worked on board the Hindenburg LZ-129 and survived the Airship Fire^[16]

HMS Hood

HMS Hood was commissioned in 1920. On May 24th 1941 she was ordered to intercept the German Battleship Bismarck with HMS Prince of Wales. Early in the Battle of the Demark Strait HMS Hood was struck and sunk after its explosion. Despite being hit she managed to strike Bismarck causing her to steer for safety, 1419 crew lost their lives in the sinking, only 3 survived.



HMS Hood

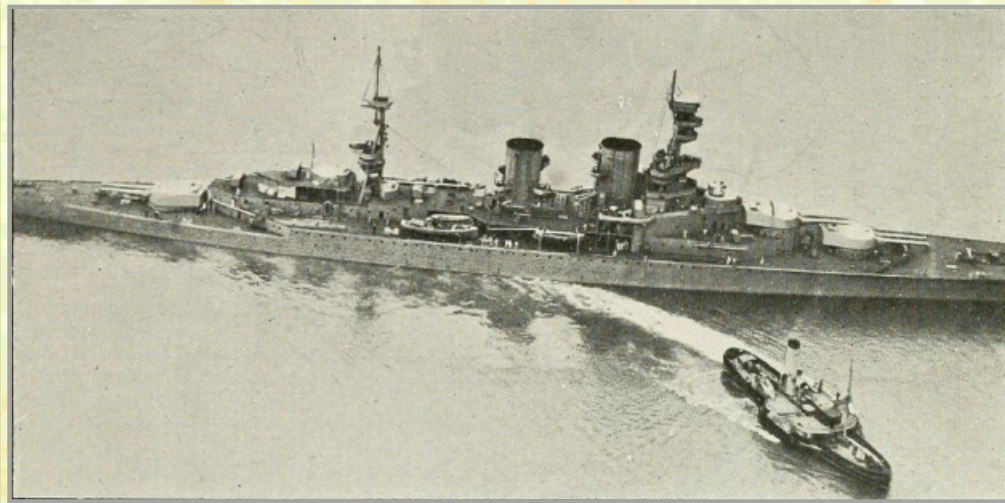
- Mr. Ronald Bower (b.1920) English Stoker 1st Class serving for the Royal Navy from Marlpool, Derbyshire, England, who sailed into battle and died in the HMS Hood sinking^[5]
- Mr. Reginald P Bower (b.1923) English Able Seaman serving for the Royal Navy from Westbourne, Hampshire, England, who sailed into battle and died in the HMS Hood sinking^[5]

SURNAME VARIANTS OF BOWER

- Mr. Leo S Bowers (b.1918) English Ordinary Seaman serving for the Royal Navy from Knowle, Hampshire, England, who sailed into battle and died in the HMS Hood sinking^[5]

HMS REPULSE

HMS Repulse was one of the world's fastest battleships. She participated in many campaigns during her time, but eventually sunk on the 10th of December 1941 by a Japanese Aircraft. After witnessing the explosion of the HMS Hood she took torpedo fire and quickly capsized, 508 men lost their lives.



HMS REPULSE

- Mr. Frank Bower, British Stoker 1st Class, who sailed into battle on the HMS Repulse (1941) and died in the sinking^[3]

HMS VANGUARD

On the 19th July 1917 the HMS Vanguard was running exercises before anchoring in the Scapa Flow off the coast of Orkney Islands, Scotland. Shortly before midnight while anchored she suffered a series of magazine explosions. No one knew anything was amiss until the first detonation at 23:20. She sank almost instantly with only three of her crew being rescued; one lost his life shortly after.



BRITISH BATTLESHIPS OF THE FIRST WORLD WAR HMS VANGUARD ON COMPLETION

SURNAME VARIANTS OF BOWER

- Mr. Alan J. Bowers (1894-1917) British Leading Seaman, who was aboard the ship "HMS Vanguard" when she exploded in the Scapa Flow off the Orkney Islands, Scotland on 9th July 1917

USS ARIZONA

The Japanese attack on Pearl Harbor began shortly after 8.00 local time on the 7th December 1941, the aircraft deployed from six aircraft carriers struck the Pacific Fleet as it sat in the harbor, and the USS Arizona was one of these ships defending Hawaii. The Air raid alarm started on board at 7.55, shortly after 8.00 ten Nakajima B5N torpedo bombers started their attack with several near misses as small ricochets' they struck USS Arizona in the vicinity of Turret II believing to have penetrated the armored deck near the ammunition magazines, causing the forward magazines to detonate and create a cataclysmic explosion, causing 1177 of the 1512 crewmen aboard the USS Arizona to lose their lives. There is a memorial in place in Pearl Harbor across the ship's sunken remains which includes a shrine room listing the names of the lost crew members.



USS ARIZONA

SURNAME VARIANTS OF BOWER

- Mr. Harold Walter Bauer, American Radioman Third Class from Kansas, USA working aboard the ship "USS Arizona" when she sunk during the Japanese attack on Pearl Harbor on 7th December 1941, he died in the sinking^[17]

USS INDIANAPOLIS

The USS Indianapolis was on a top-secret mission delivering uranium to the Tinian Naval Base as well as other parts required for the atomic bomb "Little Boy", which would eventually be dropped on Hiroshima. Upon completion of her duty she was to return the crew to Leyte for training, on the 30th July she was struck by torpedoes from the Japanese submarine I-58. There was 1,195 crewmen aboard the ship when she was struck, of that number 300 went down with the ship, the remaining crew were stranded in the water, as their mission was so top-secret no one knew they were in the area. The stranded survivors faced exposure and dehydration for 4 days prior to being spotted, but many also died from these as well as saltwater poisoning and shark attacks. As there had not been enough life boats or like jackets those 4 days were bleak. Once they were spotted and rescue attempts started only 316 crewmen were saved, of those 2 died after from their injuries.



INDIANAPOLIS OFF MARE ISLAND ON 10 JULY 1945

SURNAME VARIANTS OF BOWER

- John William Burrs (1923-1945) American crew member on board the ship "USS Indianapolis" when she was on a top secret trip for the first nuclear weapon, she was sunk by Japanese Navy on 30th July 1945, he was one of the many who were killed in the sinking due to exposure, dehydration, saltwater poisoning and shark attacks^[18]



APPENDIX - SETTLERS LIST

AMERICAN SETTLERS

- Henry Bower who settled in Virginia in 1637
- Richard Bower, who arrived in Maryland in 1664 ^[1]
- Samuel Bower, who landed in Maryland in 1668 ^[1]
- Mary Bower, who landed in Maryland in 1678 ^[1]
- Robert Bower, who settled in Virginia in 1698
- William Bower, who landed in Virginia in 1706 ^[1]
- Susanna Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1732 ^[1]
- Martin Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1732 ^[1]
- Barbara Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1732 ^[1]
- Helena Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1732 ^[1]
- Chrisn Bower, aged 17, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1737 ^[1]
- Michell Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1737 ^[1]
- Johan Nicklas Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1738 ^[1]
- John Peter Bower, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1738 ^[1]
- Petter Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1739 ^[1]
- John Paul Bower, aged 23, who landed in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania in 1741 ^[1]
- Ulrich Bower, aged 21, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1743 ^[1]
- Johannes Bower, aged 38, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1743 ^[1]
- Hendrick Bower, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1753 ^[1]
- Diedk Bower, aged 24, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1753 ^[1]
- Mich Bower, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1761 ^[1]
- Michael Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1765 ^[1]
- Paul Bower, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1765 ^[1]
- Charles Bower, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1765 ^[1]
- Jacob Bower, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1765 ^[1]
- Michael Bower, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1767 ^[1]
- Christian Bower, who arrived in Frederick County, Maryland in 1772 ^[1]
- George Bower, who landed in New York in 1773 ^[1]

- Adam Frederick Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1803-1827^[1]
- Thomas I Bower, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1803-1827^[1]
- Johann Ludwig Bower, aged 5, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1805^[1]
- Christiana Bower, aged 28, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1805^[1]
- Christina Bower, aged 3, who arrived in Pennsylvania in 1805^[1]
- Christoph Bower, aged 35, who landed in Pennsylvania in 1805^[1]
- James Bower, who arrived in America in 1807^[1]
- Alexander Bower, who landed in New York in 1810^[1]
- John Plant Bower, who landed in New York in 1811^[1]
- Alexander, Bower Jr., who landed in New York in 1822^[1]
- Andrew Bower, who landed in New York in 1822^[1]
- William Bower, who landed in New York in 1822^[1]
- Fiddle Bower, aged 44, who arrived in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1823^[1]
- Adam Bower, who landed in Mississippi in 1824^[1]
- Adam F Bower, who landed in Somerset County, Pennsylvania in 1824^[1]
- Joseph Bower, who arrived in Baltimore, Maryland in 1833^[1]
- Anthony Bower, who landed in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1838^[1]
- Mathew Bower, who arrived in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1839^[1]
- Mathias Bower, who landed in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1839^[1]
- Anton Bower, aged 26, who arrived in Missouri in 1840^[1]
- Thomas Bower, who landed in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Maryland in 1840^[1]
- John Adam Bower, who arrived in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1842^[1]
- Lewis Bower, who arrived in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1844^[1]
- Therese Bower, who arrived in America in 1846^[1]
- L Bower, who landed in San Francisco, California in 1850^[1]
- Henry Bower, who landed in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1850^[1]
- D Bower, who arrived in San Francisco, California in 1850^[1]
- Adams Bower, who arrived in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1851^[1]
- John Bower, who arrived in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1852^[1]
- Sophia Bower, aged 48, who arrived in Ohio in 1875^[1]
- Ludwig Bower, aged 24, who arrived in Ohio in 1875^[1]
- Grete Bower, aged 11, who arrived in Ohio in 1875^[1]
- Louisa Bower, aged 24, who landed in Nebraska in 1880^[1]

CANADIAN SETTLERS

- Mr. John Bower, "Adam" U.E. who settled in Canada c. 1783^[19]
- Mr. Adam Bower U.E. who settled in Ernestown, Lennox & Addington, Ontario c. 1783^[19]
- Mr. Adam Bower U.E. who settled in Fredericksburgh, Cataraqui township, [Greater Napanee], Ontario c. 1783^[19]
- Mr. Adam Bower U.E. who settled in Canada c. 1783^[19]
- Mr. Gasher Bower U.E. who settled in Fredericksburgh, Cataraqui township, [Greater Napanee], Ontario c. 1783^[19]

AUSTRALIAN SETTLERS

- Mary Bower, who arrived in Adelaide, Australia aboard the ship "Winchester" in 1838^[20]
- Thomas Bower, who arrived in Adelaide, Australia aboard the ship "Winchester" in 1838^[20]
- Jane Bower, who arrived in Adelaide, Australia aboard the ship "William Nicol" in 1840^[21]
- Thomas Wilson Bower, English convict from Cheshire, who was transported aboard the "Anna Maria" on March 6, 1848, settling in Van Diemen's Land, Australia^[22]
- J. Bower, who arrived in Adelaide, Australia aboard the ship "John Woodall" in 1849^[23]
- John Bower, aged 31, who arrived in South Australia in 1852 aboard the ship "Amazon"^[24]
- Ellen Bower, aged 26, a farm servant, who arrived in South Australia in 1854 aboard the ship "James Fernie"^[25]
- Henry John Bower, aged 35, a mason, who arrived in South Australia in 1854 aboard the ship "Star Queen"^[26]
- Sarah Bower, aged 14, a servant, who arrived in South Australia in 1854 aboard the ship "Star Queen"^[26]
- Julia Bower, aged 18, a domestic servant, who arrived in South Australia in 1855 aboard the ship "Northern Light"^[27]
- John Bower, aged 24, a saddler, who arrived in South Australia in 1855 aboard the ship "Aliquis"
- Mr. John Bower, English convict who was convicted in Salsbury (New Sarum), Wiltshire, England for 10 years, transported aboard the "Edwin Fox" on 24th August 1858, arriving in Western Australia, Australia^[28]
- Arthur Bower, aged 31, British settler who arrived in Adelaide, South Australia aboard the "Hesperus" in 1883

NEW ZEALAND SETTLERS

- David Bower, aged 28, a gardener, who arrived in Otago aboard the ship "Philip Laing" in 1848
- Jean Bower, aged 22, who arrived in Otago aboard the ship "Philip Laing" in 1848
- Mr. David Bower, Scottish settler travelling from Greenock aboard the ship "Philip Laing" arriving in Otago, South Island, New Zealand on 15th April 1848 ^[29]
- Mrs. Bower, Scottish settler travelling from Greenock aboard the ship "Philip Laing" arriving in Otago, South Island, New Zealand on 15th April 1848 ^[29]
- Mr. Adam Bower, (b. 1821), aged 36, British stonemason travelling from London aboard the ship "Roehampton" arriving in Lyttlelton, Christchurch, South Island, New Zealand on 7th March 1858 ^[29]





Here is a listing of some of the sources consulted when researching German surnames. The resources below directly or indirectly influenced the authors of our surname histories. We have most of these titles in our library, others we have borrowed or had access to. Source materials have been chosen for their reliability and authenticity. Our research into surnames is ongoing, and we are continually adding to our source library. For each surname history, we seek and refer to sources specific to the surname; these are generally not included in the list below.

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